



Getting To Better Personas

Getting the most value out of both distributed content and your owned media strategy.

TCA Webinar



Your Hosts



Robert Rose

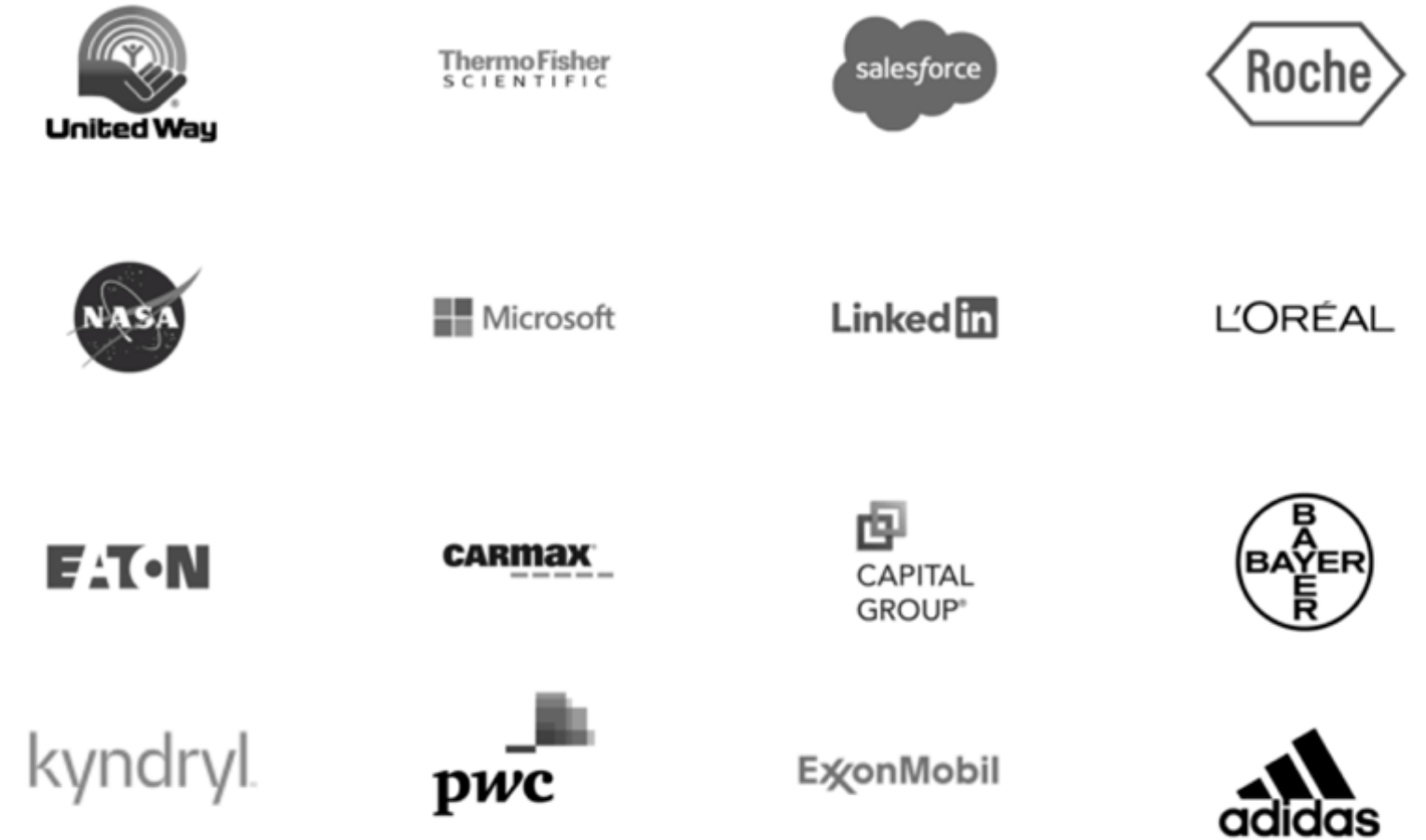
Chief Strategy Officer
Author, Speaker, Troublemaker



Cathy McKnight

Chief Problem Solver
Advisor, Speaker, Explorer

WE WORK WITH GREAT COMPANIES



What we're going to talk about today

- ❑ Why Customer Personas Matter
- ❑ Building Personas That Actually Work
- ❑ Matching Content to the Customer Journey
- ❑ Turning Engagement into Conversions

And we have a Special Guest

REMEMBER
ALL AUDIENCES ARE CUSTOMERS
BUT ONLY SOME CUSTOMERS BUY OUR PRODUCTS

Power of Personas

Companies with well-defined customer personas see a **171% increase in marketing-generated revenue** compared to those that do not.

*

82% of companies that use personas say they have **improved their value propositions and messaging.**

**

93% of businesses that exceed their lead and revenue goals attribute their success to segmentation and persona-based marketing

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* Source: Cintel

** Source: ITSMA

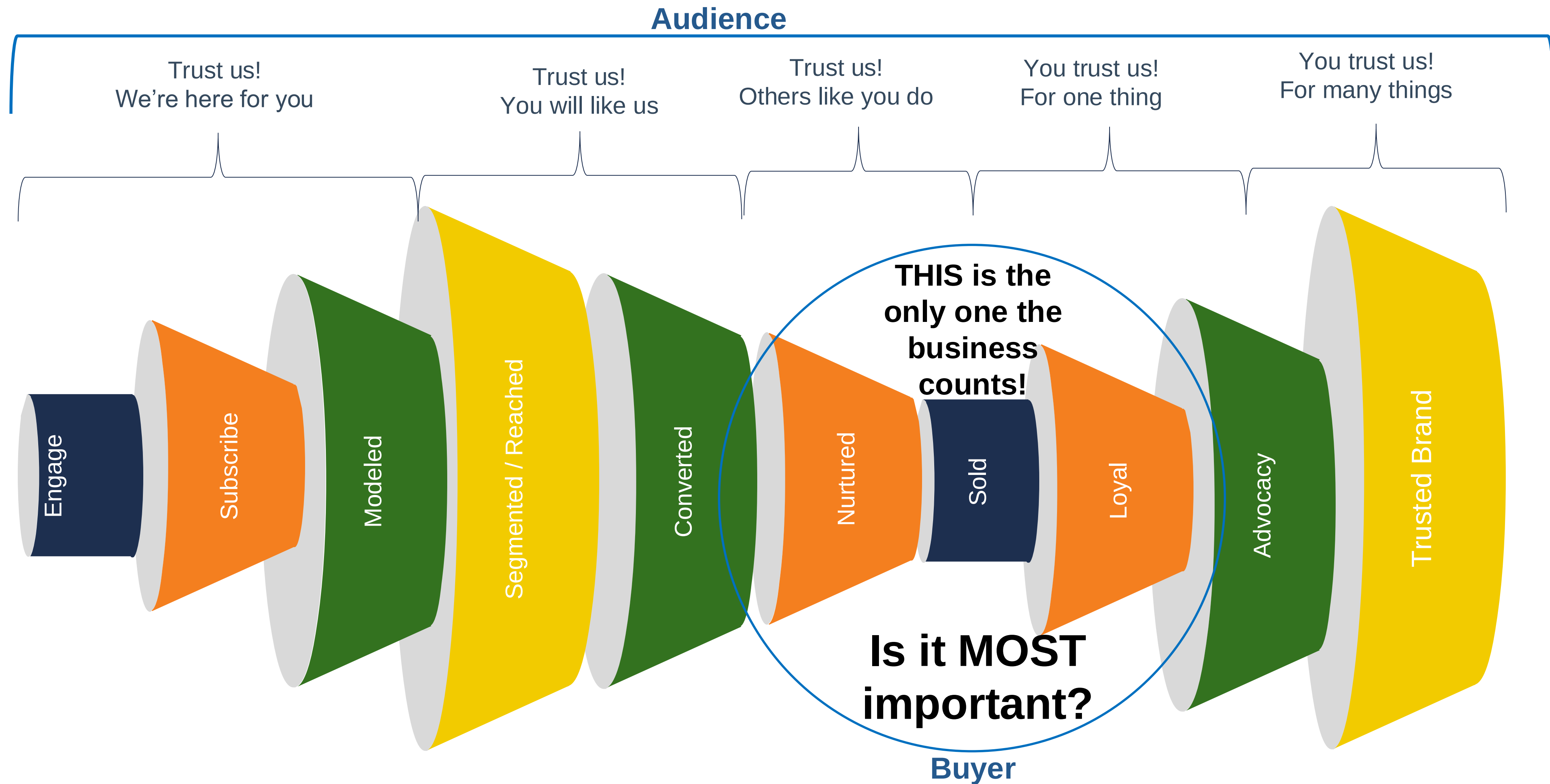
Personas: A starting point for all great experiences

Personas help ...



Personas help to keep EVERYONE – from designers to channel experts to sales teams – focused on what the target audience wants and needs.

We integrate content across the ENTIRE journey



Audiences are More than Buyers

Mapped experiences that have clear purpose, focus, and goals

Buyer personas are useful – for the stage of the customer’s journey where they are... you know...

Buying something.

Companies often develop buyer’s personas looking only through the lens of our brand, our product, and how they acquire



Kelly

The “On-The-Go” Parent

Motivations

Detail-oriented

Cares deeply about education

Loves to travel, eat, tour, etc.

Lifestyle

Works in career and manages

family – the family CEO/CFO

Pain points / challenges

Time savings. She’s unable to keep up. Frustrated with all her lists. Wants mobile integration with her tasks, schedules, and to-do lists.

“I really wish I had an app on my phone that would let me automatically organize everything in one place. And let me do it in a way that I want.”

Personas are more than data points & stock photos

True personas focus on **motivations, goals, challenges, behavioural traits, and preferences**—factors that directly inform effective content and messaging strategies.

Robust personas have:

- **Demographic details:** Age, marital status, income
- **Personal details:** Name, short biography, photograph
- **Attitudinal and/or cognitive details:** mental model, pain points, feelings about the tasks that need to be accomplished
- **Goals and motivations** for using the product
- **Behavioral details:** how the persona acts when using the product

The image shows two examples of robust personas. The first is Isabel Marques, a woman with dark hair, wearing a patterned top. Her profile includes a name field, a photo, a quote: "My work doesn't require a physical presence. I'm doing great, my boss tries to give us an equal work environment, but that's for now.", and a background section stating "Isabel has been working remotely since the pandemic's onset". The second is Chloe, a woman with glasses and dark hair, wearing a blue top. Her profile includes a name field, a photo, and a table for demographic and professional details.

Chloe		
Buyer Persona Example #1		
Demographics	Age	
	Language	
	Location	
	Education	
	Annual Income	
Family Status		
Profession/Career	Job Title	
	Industry	



The diagram shows a persona's challenges and pressure points. It includes a list of activities: "Running (twice weekly)", "Travelling", and "Walking the dog". A central box titled "CHALLENGES & PRESSURE POINTS" states: "Kate and her husband must both work to provide their family with the quality of life that they would like them to have, however neither of their jobs allow for flexible working. While they have a comfortable life, they are not able to save frequently to pay for things such as family holidays." To the right, another box notes: "includes giving them the best education possible, but also ensuring that they grow up to be well-rounded individuals."

When building a persona:

Consider:

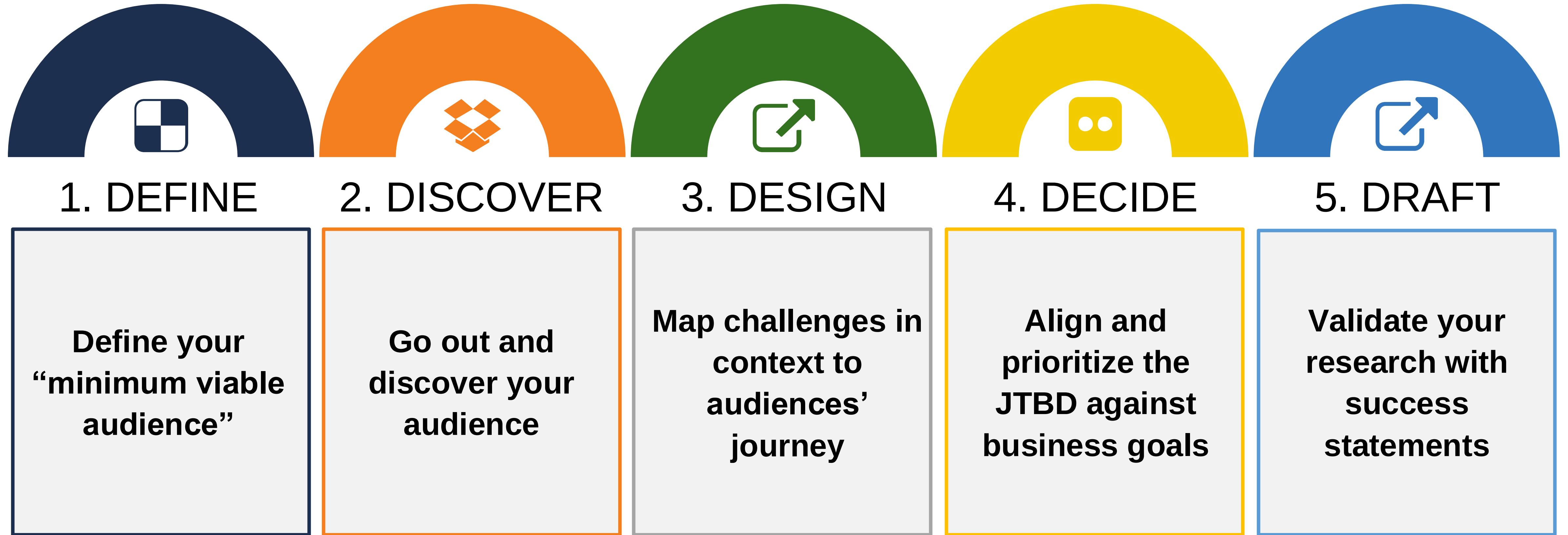
- Behaviours
- Attitudes
- Jobs To Be Done
- Roles
- Tasks
- Channels used
- Devices used
- Challenges
- Access environments/location
- Physical or technical limitations
- Motivations
- Goals
- Demographic data

Then look for commonalities:

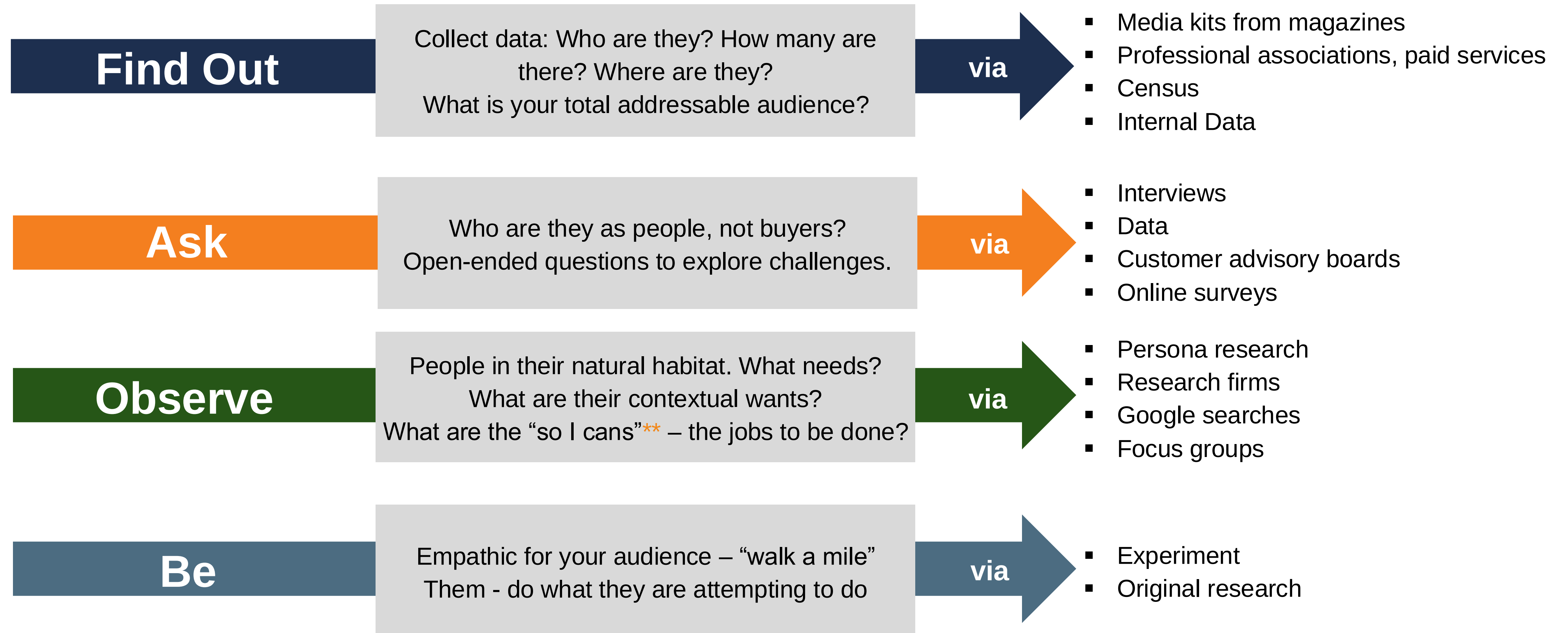
- Type of person
- Goals
- Personal motivations
- Locations
- Levels of savviness on topic/brand/...
- Common tasks
- Frequently used applications
- Frequently referenced information
- Barriers to successful journey
- Physical work environment conditions
- Familiarity with the organization

Jobs to be done (JTBD) refers to a business theory, framework, and perspective on why customers buy products or services. Focusing on the user problems and needs, and the outcomes they desire.

Building Audience Personas – 5 Steps to Success



Step 1: Define Your Audience



** I want ... so that I can ... <goal, wish, ...>

Example of a Defined Audience

The Capital Group

Find Out

From research of 285,000 financial advisors in the United States

- 20%-25% are certified
- Total addressable audience is then: 70,000
- Minimum viable audience: 7,000 (a 10% penetration)

Ask

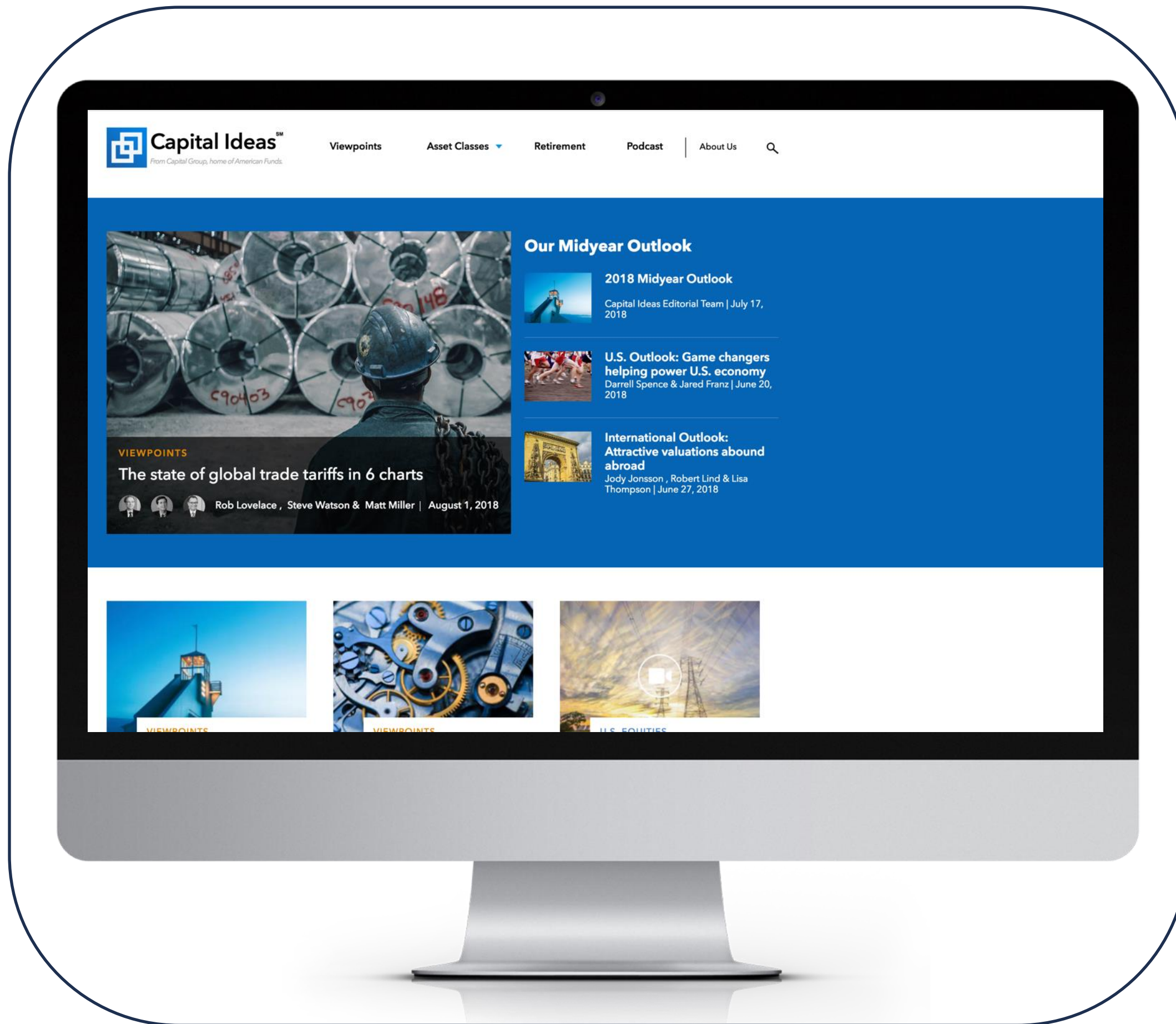
Hired company to interview 50 of them. Covered topics from work/life balance to future of their career, industry, etc.

Observe

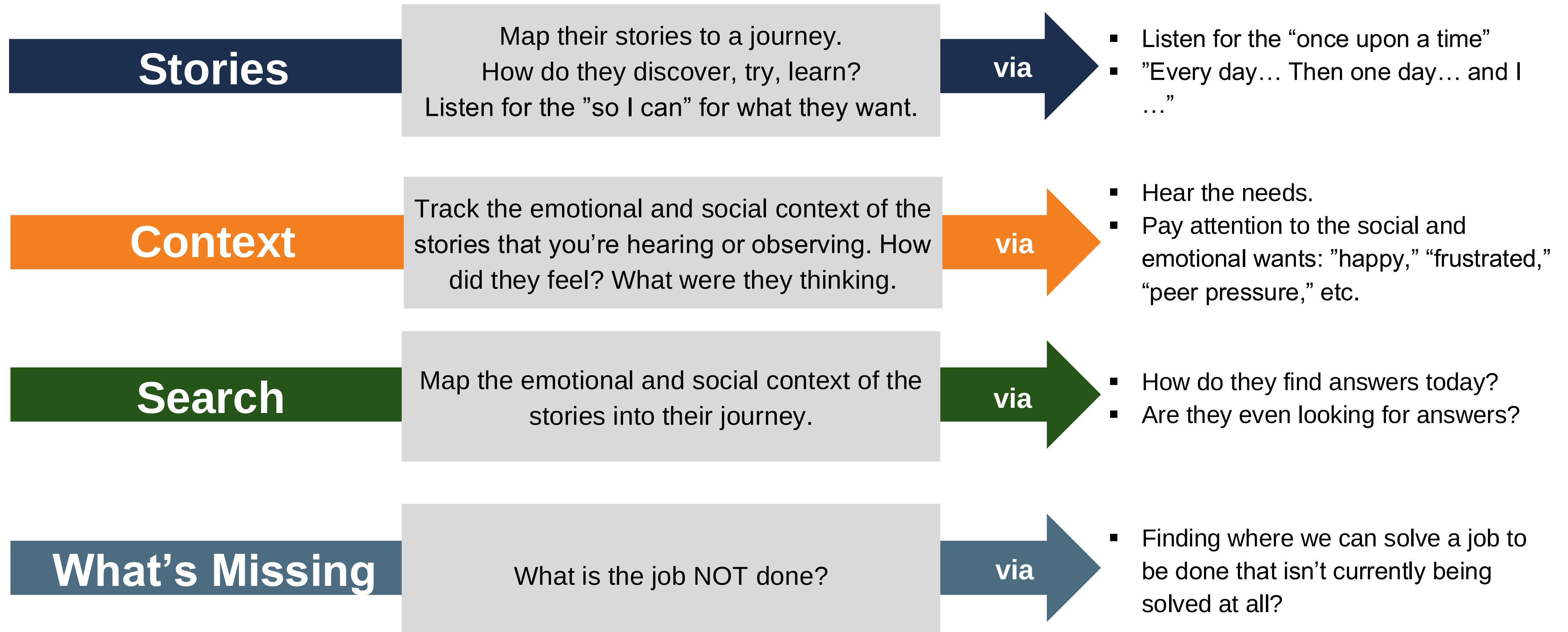
- Attended competitor events.
- Watched traffic and Google trends.

Be

Spent time with the target audience and learned about lack of time to relax and the challenge of learning in today's environment.



Step 2: Discover Audiences' full story, not just how they buy.

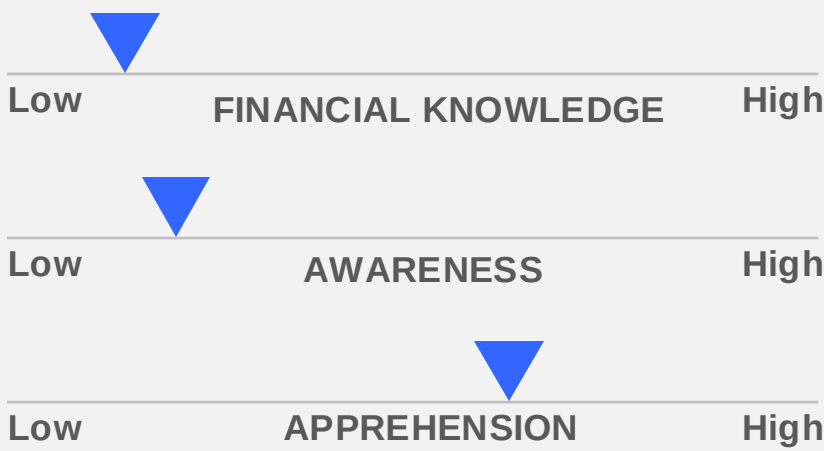




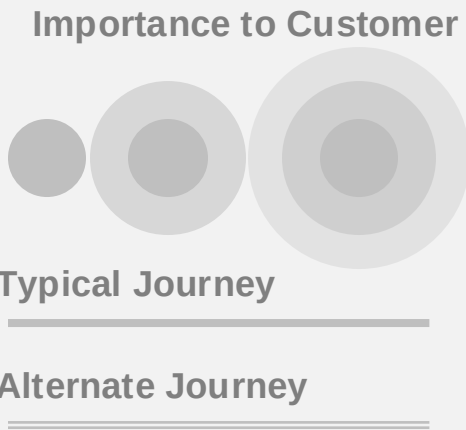
Jessica Rhodes

SAMPLE JOURNEY MAP

A teacher of ten years, she doesn’t have/make time to research their retirement/investment options and aren’t interested in making personal finance decisions right now. They need someone to provide sound advice.



“I have a pension, so we are already half way covered. I’d like to talk to someone to get an idea of when we should start planning for the future.”



NEEDS & EXPECTATIONS

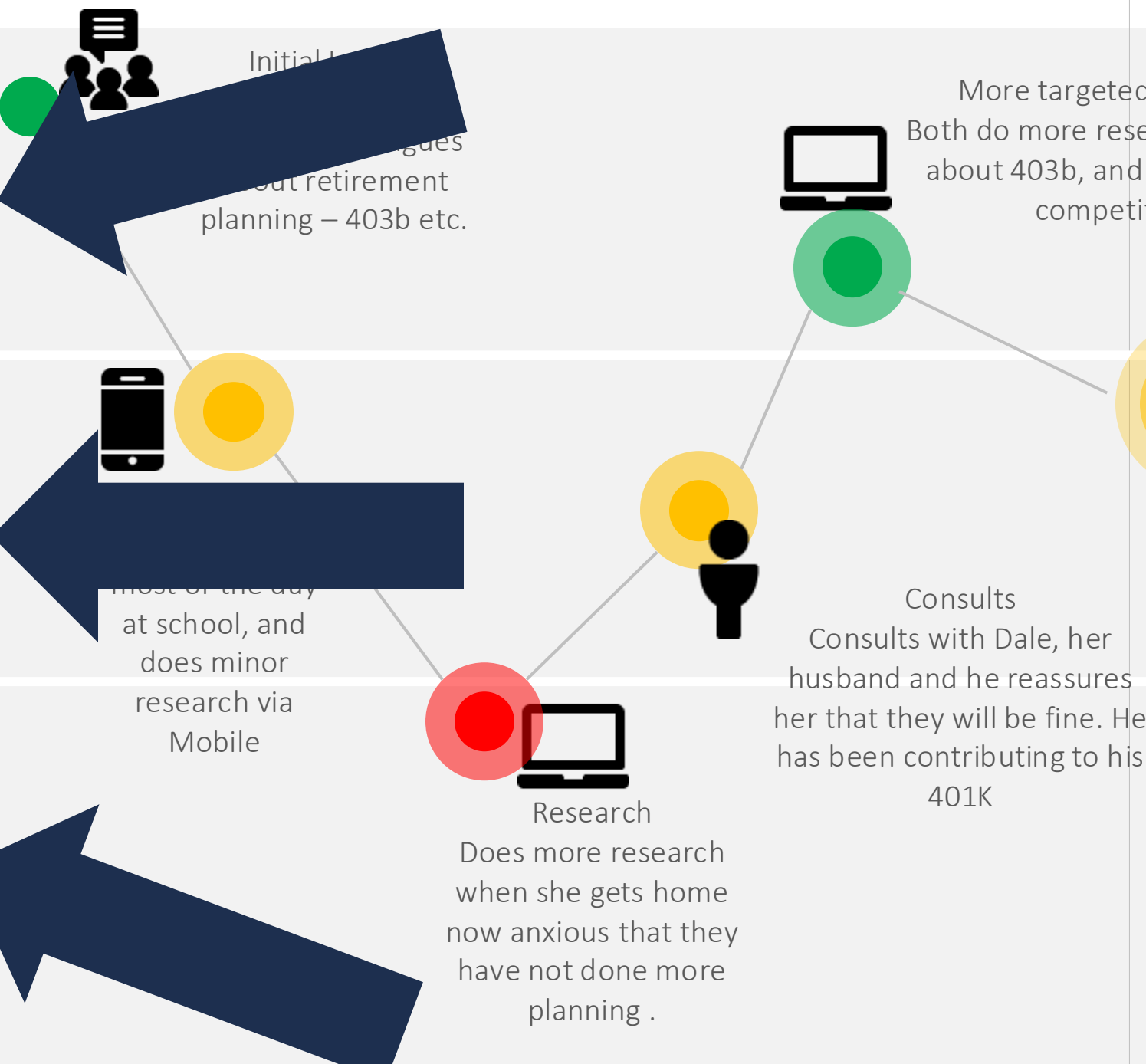


CONTENT & TOOLS



PHASE 1 – Discovery of Need

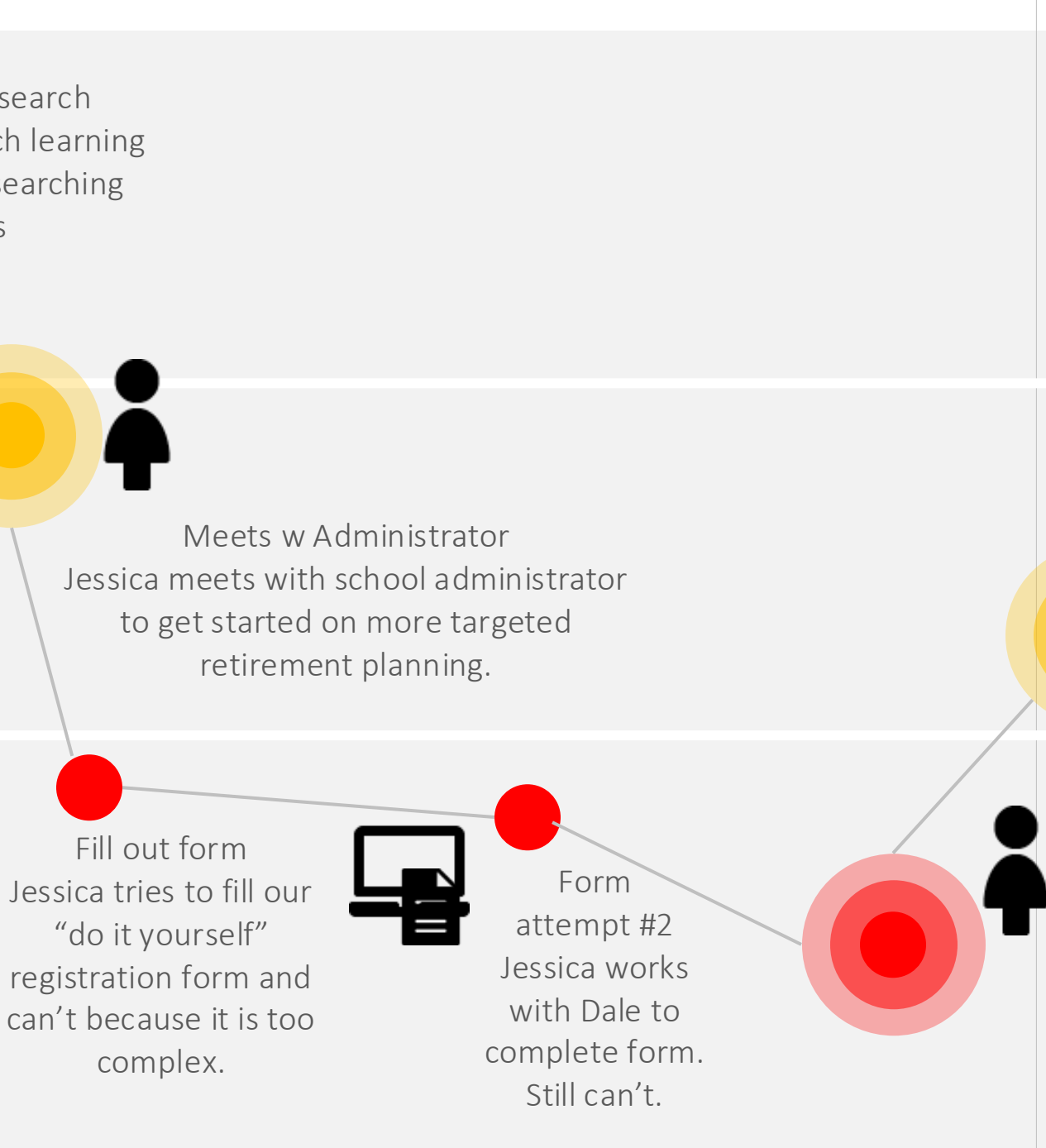
- Support from her school board administrator to understand what she current has, and what other options are available.
- Retirement investment/savings options specific for teachers.



- Savings Calculators: retirement, tuition, mortgage
- Pension Calculators
- Links to teacher-specific resources

PHASE 2 – Awareness

- Advisor to have specific knowledge of teacher retirement benefits and best-fit options from CLIENT portfolio of options to complement what she has.



- Case studies
- Infographics
- Short articles/blog posts: retirement, savings, etc.
- Aspirational content
- Impact content: “How saving \$5/day can make all the difference”

PHASE 3 – Information Gathering

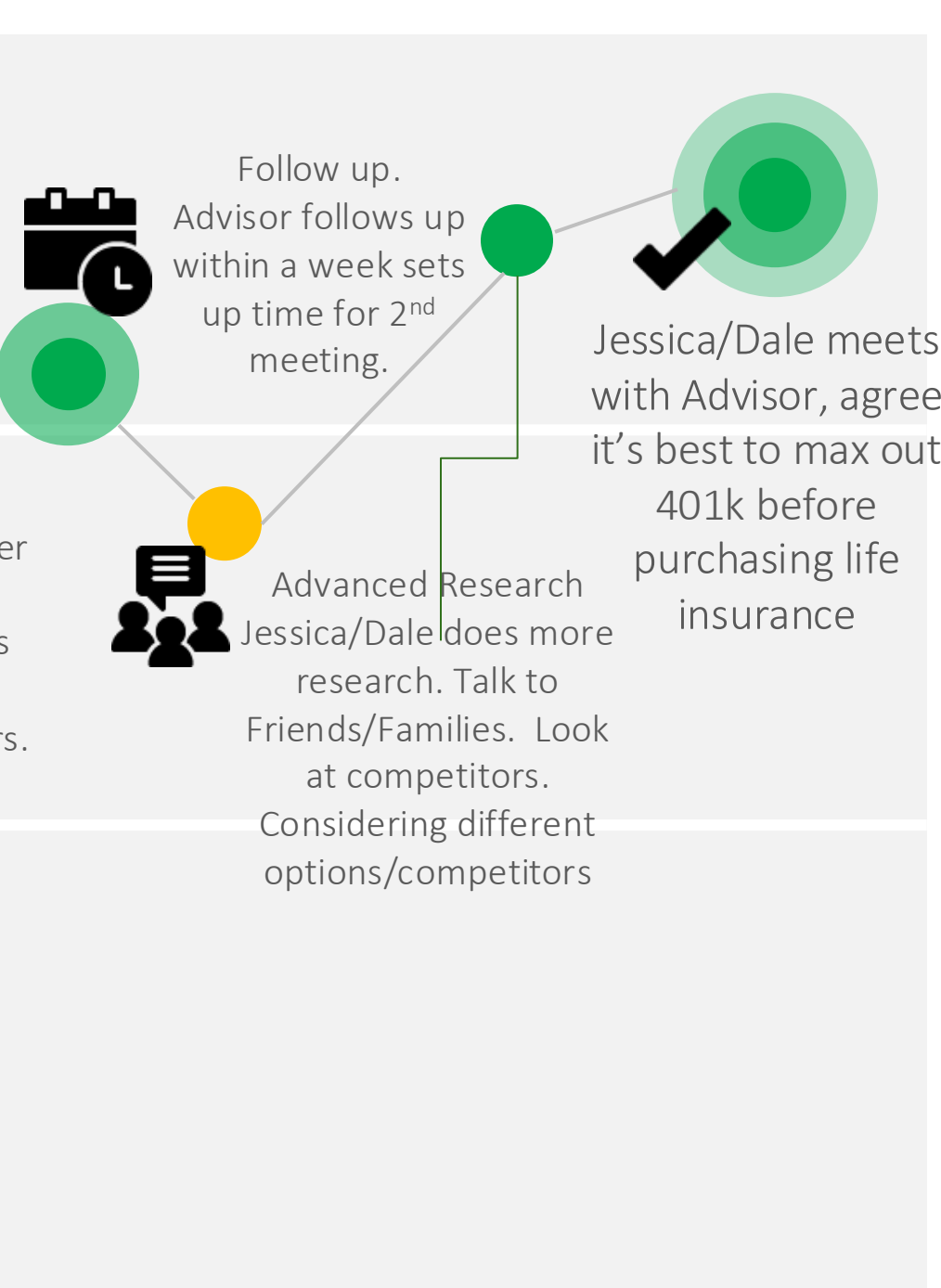
- Information to be delivered to her proactively.
- Content which she identifies herself.



- Savings Calculators
- Pension Calculators
- Teacher specific resources
- Teacher specific events

PHASE 4 – Decisioning

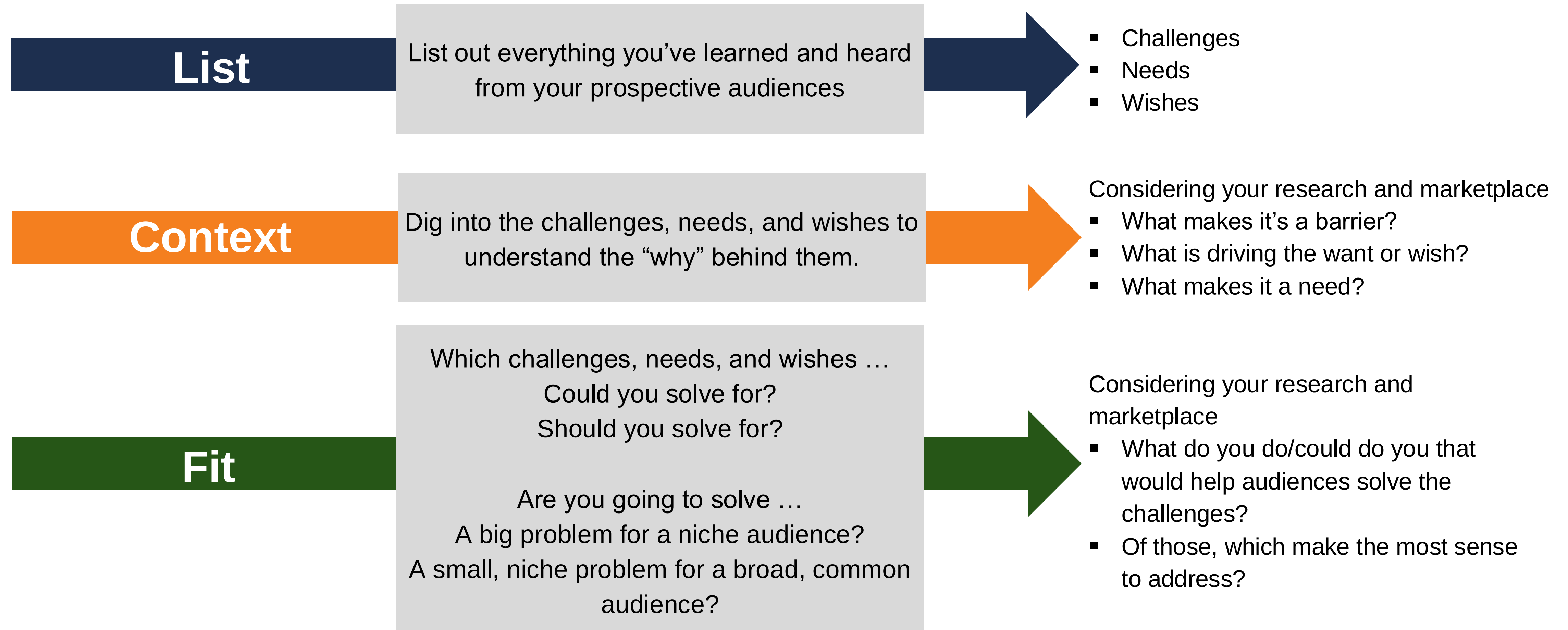
- Regular check-ins from Advisor.
- Pro-active suggestions for changes or new investment/saving opportunities that suit her.



- Short articles/blog posts: retirement, savings, etc.
- Aspirational content
- Impact content

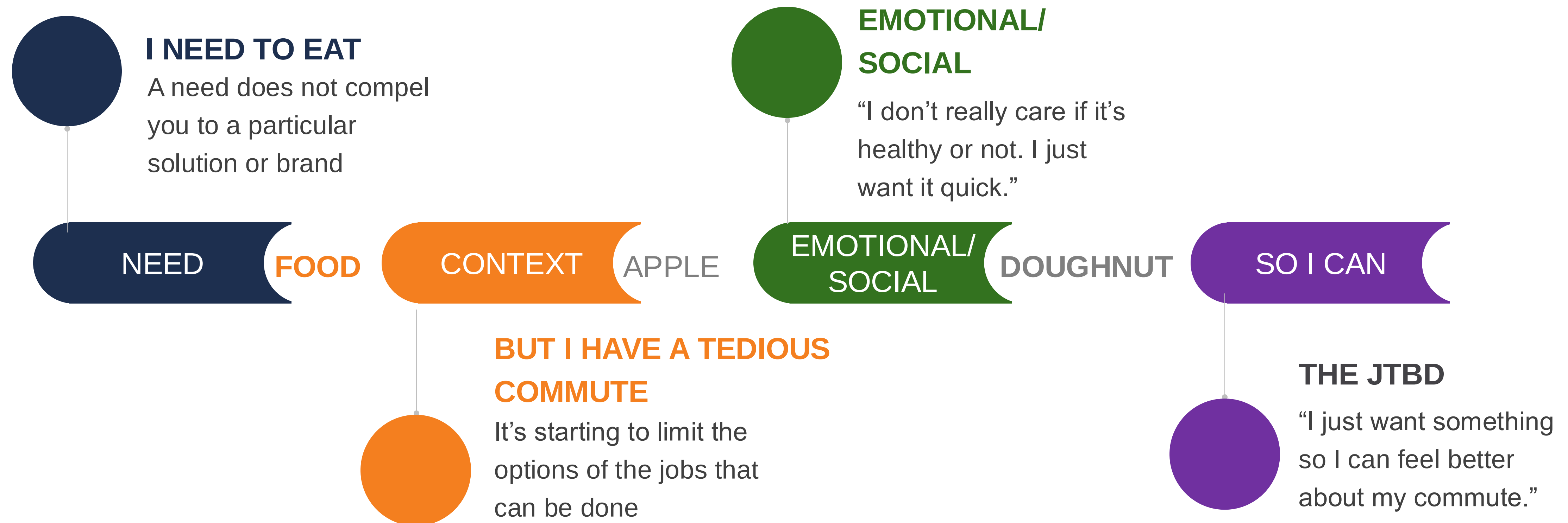
Step 3: Design the Jobs to be Solved

Defining the “Jobs to be Done” (JTBD) focuses on the direct outcome a customer wants to achieve with your product. Personas help explain how the audience would go about reaching that goal.



Step 3 – Find the “So I Can”

“When I’m rushing to work, and I’m starting my long commute and I have no time to stop. But I’m hungry and just want something to eat that is quick, easy, and that tastes good. I want to find something I can have so I feel better about my commute.”



Example of Jobs to be Solved



Lincoln Electric

List

Interviewed artists and makers and specifically focused on wood working sculptors. Discovered that 80% of them wanted to get into welding but were afraid of how dangerous it was.

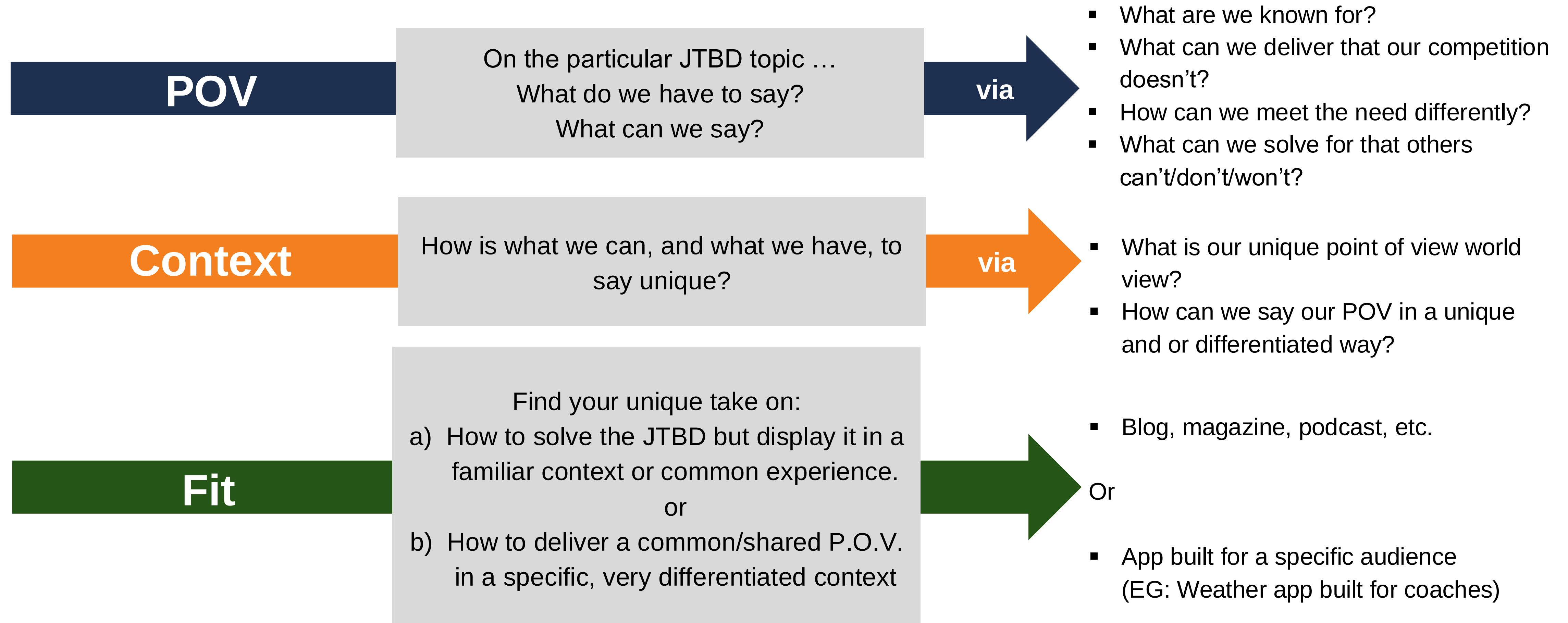
Context

They really wanted to learn but didn't want to be in the same "classes" as those who were looking to it as a career. Afraid of being mocked.

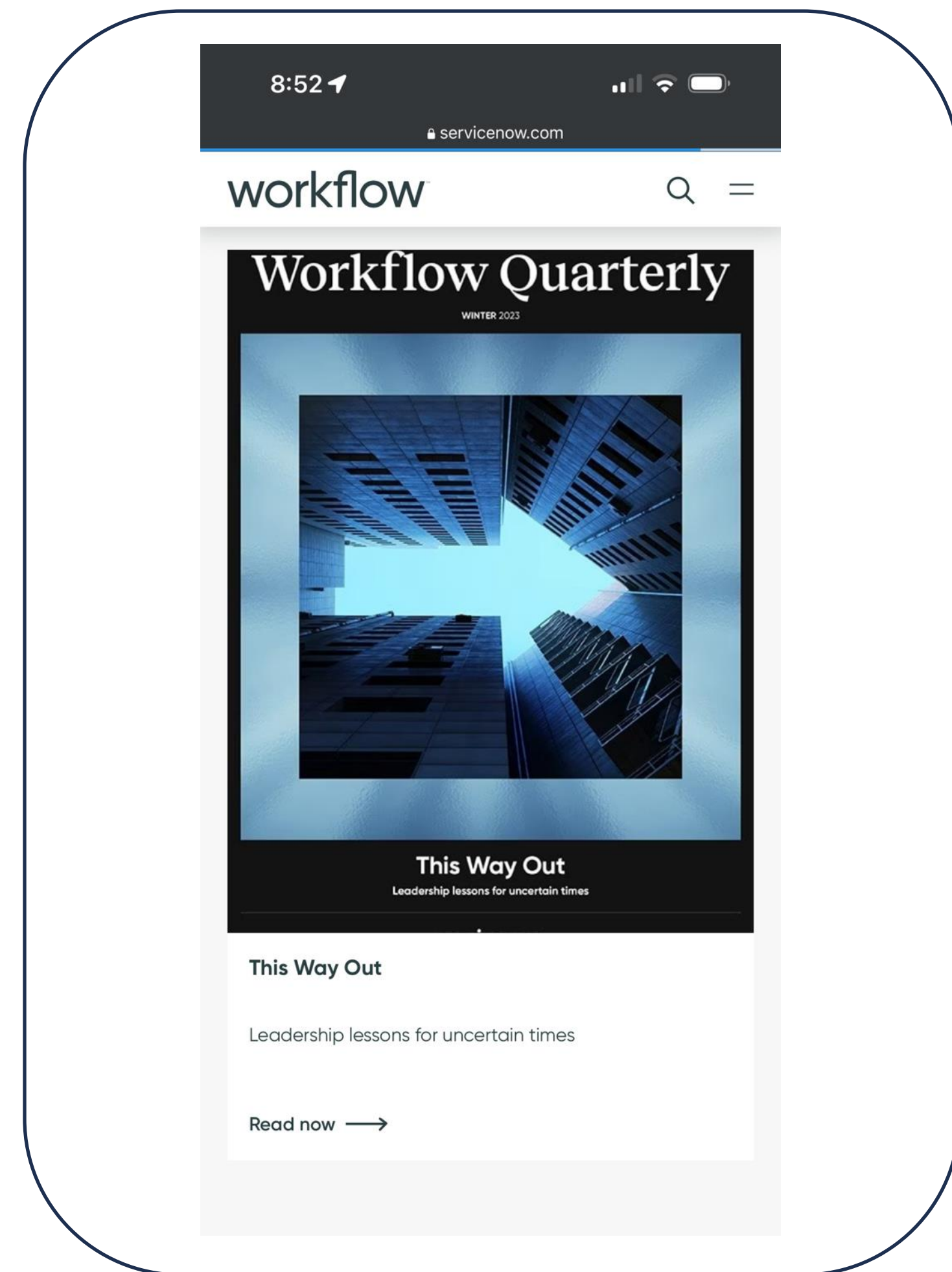
Fit with what they heard from artists

"I wish there was a way I could learn about welding that didn't make me feel dumb, and that could show me the way. I want to get into welding but I'm afraid it's just too hard and complex. I want to learn on my own time, so I can create some really cool new pieces of art."

Step 4: Decide



Example of Deciding on the JTBD



Service Now Finds their Unique POV

ServiceNow

Mid-sized software company focused on providing technology platforms for workflow and project management

Workflow Magazine

A publication to help C-Level audiences learn (through thought leadership about workflow)

Editor's Stated Strategy

“Cover technology in the service of people rather than the other way around.” **They chose a NICHE topic – through a VERY common interface.**

Step 5: Draft

Validate

Get ready to write the success statements for the problem you are solving. Validate and identify specifics of the value.

- Review data
- Do more targeted interviews
- Listen for keywords, messages, and opportunities.

Map

Map the value, key words, outcomes to build your success statement.

Value Action + Success metric + Job Action + Clarifying Context/Emotion

Write

Success Statement

When. I am working, I don't need more software, I need automation, research tools and help that gives me the freedom to work on my business. I want peace of mind so I can feel better about spending time working on building the law practice of the future.

Value action

Success metric

Success metric

Clarifying context

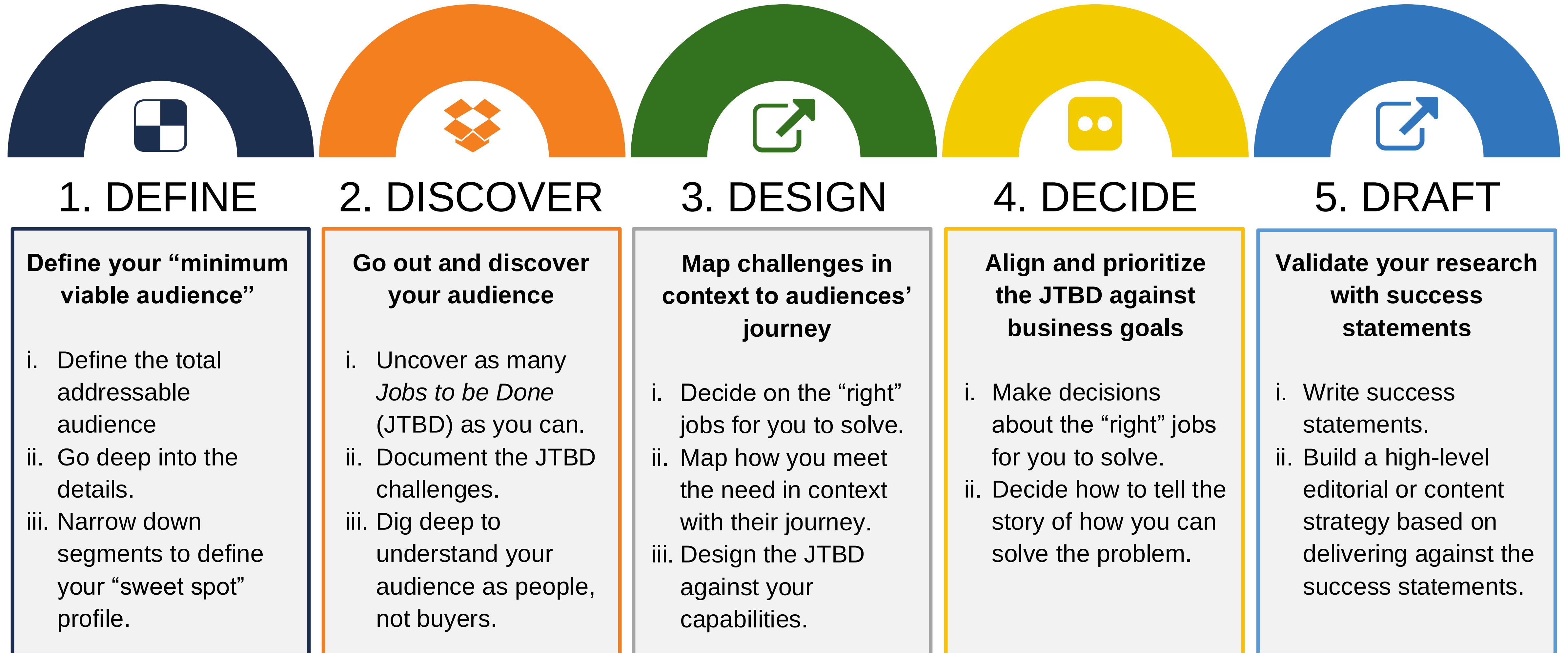
Job action

Success Statements to Content Architecture

Value Action + Success metric + Job Action + Clarifying Context/Emotion

Baseline for your content architecture			
Value	Success Metrics	Job Actions	Clarifying Context/Emotions
Learn welding	Easy	Formal classes	Embarrassed – beginner
Build cool art	Less time-consuming	Tutors/mentors	Speak my language
Meet artist/welders	Fun/inspiring	Events	Know me
Learn specific welds	Virtual	Downloadable	Want to have fun, joyful
Mix mediums	Inexpensive	Updated	Safe

Building Audience Personas – 5 Steps to Success



Our Special Guest

Susan Baier

Founder & CEO of Audience Audit Inc.

www.audienceaudit.com

- Professional Speaker
- Badass Researcher
- Thought Leadership Strategist

Susan likes to camp, knit, and enjoys a good bourbon... sometimes simultaneously.

Best quote: “Yah, we don’t do that.”



Big things coming in 2025



Seventh Bear

Next Online Event: January 23, 2025

Teamwork: Unlocking the Magic of Collaboration

Are you ready to discover the power of being part of a well-structured, collaborative team?

We'll share the wisdom we've garnered working with hundreds of teams on how aligned teamwork transforms creativity, streamlines processes, and drives success. Say goodbye to the cacophony of unconnected teams, or worse, the static of their silence, while we share practical strategies to boost collaboration, align goals, and amplify impact.

Join us and learn about:

- **The Collaboration Edge:** Learn how structured teamwork sparks creativity, speeds up workflows, and enhances marketing results.
- **Role Clarity = Big Wins:** Discover how clear roles and shared accountability create alignment and reduce friction.
- **How to Harmonize across Silos:** Get actionable strategies to build a cohesive, high-performing teams that deliver big results.





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